Larkspur Industry Insights
Sector research for credit and investment teams

Cold-chain logistics in Australia

Sector note, Q3 2026

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Key points

- Australian cold-chain logistics revenue was about A$9.8bn in 2025 and we forecast growth of around 6% a year to 2030.
- Utilisation of cold storage in Sydney has stayed above 90% since 2021, and new supply is constrained by land and power costs.
- Operators are consolidating: the five largest now hold an estimated 46% of the market, up from 38% in 2020.
- Labour and electricity are the main cost pressures; operators with automation and long customer contracts are best placed.

Figure 1. Australian cold-chain logistics market, 2021 to 2030F

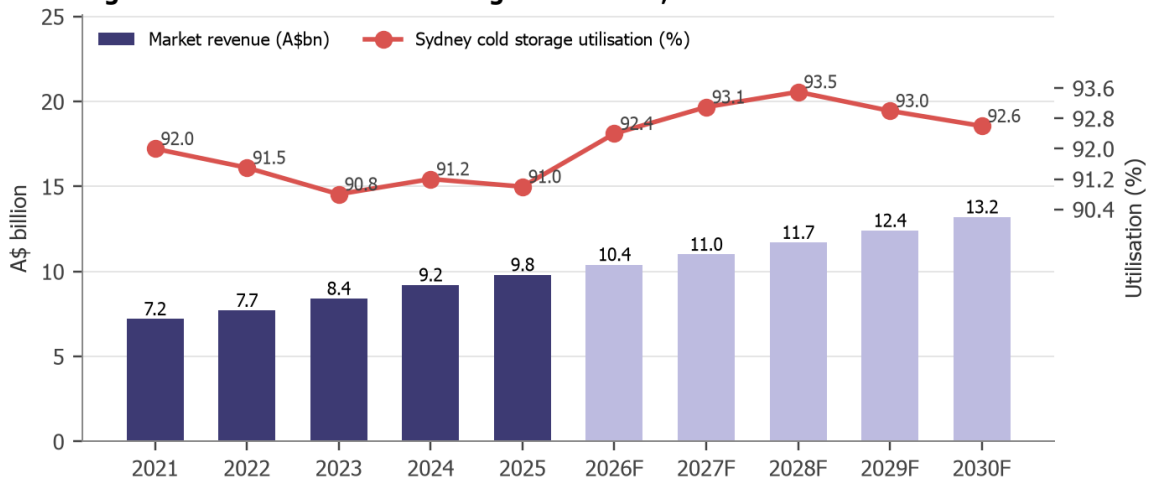


Figure 1. Market size and Sydney utilisation. Source: Larkspur estimates.

Credit considerations

Customer concentration is the most common weakness in mid-sized operators. Supermarket contracts are typically three to five years and are re-tendered on price. Lenders should test the renewal profile of the largest contracts and the pass-through of electricity costs.

Regional acquisitions have mixed records: integration of transport management systems and driver workforces commonly takes twelve to eighteen months, longer than management plans often assume.